

maintain and build up your business network and contacts. Making it easier to maintain and make new business contacts and making it a very effective way to maintain valuable business contacts. The value of the network increases as the number of members increases. The business networking sites provide more opportunities for people with membership subscriptions to look for jobs, contracts and other prospects creating viable options to make a profit on. Social networking at present is still looking for a solid business model. The business Model for social networks is unclear as how to make profits from these sites and the question remains if there is a potential revenue model. Venture capitalists continue to fund social and business networking sites however, giving rise to the speculation that there is a bubble within this niche in the market.

People on the Internet are already paying for subscriptions to various sites, especially the dating related ones. Following on from those who are willing to pay for online dating and matchmaking services, the CEOs of companies such as LinkedIn and Tribe are interested in how business people will connect for business, social or even matchmaking purposes online.

As these networking sites continue to attract and register new users every day in some cases millions of people, the race is on to find a competitive and working business model that will utilize the strength of numbers and valuable information collected. These sites can also be used to publicize a brand by targeting a company's publishing and advertising capabilities towards the large numbers of members that have signed up to a site. Social networking technology enables people to connect in a way that closely mirrors natural social behavior. These structures are fundamental to the way people organize themselves and communicate, and yet personal communication products take no account of them fully as of yet.

3 Evaluation

Some of the most popular social network sites will now be evaluated in terms of the features they offer: communication and collabo-